

CHAPTER THREE

In-School Culture/Health Classes for Elementary School (ES) and Middle School (MS)

1 Teaching Elementary School Students using sled dogs by Mari Hoe-Raitto (Salcha)

Teaching young students about sled dogs is a great way to learn about caring and learning responsibilities in life. Sled dogs can teach us so much, from every aspect like husbandry, feeding and nutrition, nursing and injuries, managing and being a leader, learning to do practical projects, social work and psychology, being motivated, loving and caring, showing empathy and just having them as your best friends. Dogs give unconditional love. Students learn about great teamwork, and not to mention sportsmanship and great social skills. Sled dogs can teach us so many life lessons!

~Example lesson plans

2. Teaching Middle School Students using sled dogs by Sam Barney (Huslia)

Students had experience with and participated in lessons related to: veterinary care of sled dogs; assisting in giving shots; giving an I.V.; feeding and general care; anatomy of race dogs; details of training and importance of keeping good records; time keeping and the physics behind dog sleds. The students helped build a dog sled and repaired several others. They learned how to tie various knots, went snowshoeing and learned the science behind weight distribution over an area. The students learned the history of dog mushing, and the history of Huslia. They read, discussed, and wrote about the native stories specific to Huslia. They were taught by elders how to live a healthy life, how to show respect, and to be proud of their native heritage. They gave service to elders in the community. The students wrote dozens of “thank you” letters to sponsors, and journal entries about their participation in the program.

~ Example lesson plans (TO BE ADDED)

3. A Sled Dog Camp week including elementary student sled dog race

After the FAYSPD was a part of the curriculum in both MS and HS, it was natural for ES students to ask about the sled dogs classes. In April when MS and HS students had their annual spring culture class camping trip down-river, students who were unable to attend culture class were recruited to mentor younger students at an in-village Sled Dog Camp. In the past these students were disheartened at being left behind. The idea for these MS/HS students to mentor youngsters came naturally. By being given mentorship responsibilities in this alternate program, the students left behind flourished. The community organized a list of adult volunteers and the school provided the names elementary students anxious to participate in the Sled Dog Camp. The culminating event of the camp was to have a elementary student sled dog race organized by the MS/HS students. The entire community participated in the event.

~Example of In-Village sled dog camp schedule

4. REFERENCES for ES and MS teachers

Physical Education By Mari Hoe-Raitto (Salsha)

Lesson #1: Life as part of a sled dog team

Grade level: k-6

Objective: learn about sport of dog mushing & being part of team

Equipment: Jump ropes, cones, mats

- Divide groups into 5 students in each group.
- Each group have 2-4 jump ropes(depends on length)
- Line students up with a leader dog, swing dog, team dog and a wheel dog.
- The Jump ropes are the dog lines.
- The musher is holding on with both hands at end of jump ropes, and every body else are too starting with lead dog, ending with musher.
- The teacher has taught the students about the sled dog vocabulary already, and this is the practice session learning about directions like Gee, right- Haw, left.
- Also work on Whoa, stop. Mush is to get started. Easy is to slow down, Faster to speed up.
- Teacher shouts off the directions of what the students should do like they are catching on the commands well, each musher in different groups takes their team around and they will use the commands.
- Teacher makes everybody whoa. Next the lead dog will be the swing dog, swing dog will be the team dog, team dog will be the wheel dog and wheel dog will be the musher.
- Rotate so every student gets to try the different positions.
- Use cones and mats as obstacles

Physical EducationBy Mari Hoe-Raitto (Salsha)

Lesson #2: On the race trail

Grade level: k-6

Objective: Follow directions, being part of a team, learn about sled dogs, Conditioning

Equipment: Hula hoops, cones, mats

- The race is on. Make teams with one child each holding on to a hula hoop.
- When teacher gives directions, students will skip, gallop, run or walk, do gee- haw and whoa.
- When stopped, students will do 5 sit ups or pull ups, the back up on their feet and run, gallop skip.
- Have students in groups of 5 get together and practice the same as they did with jump ropes, but now with hula hoops.

Physical Education By Mari Hoe-Raitto (Salsha)

Lesson #3: Sled dog relay

Grade level: k-6

Objective: Follow directions, being part of a team, learn about sled dogs, Conditioning

Equipment: plastic sleds with a 4 dog lines attached. (Fanstyle or Alaskan style) gangline. Cones

- Teams of five. Musher sits in sled while the 4 others pull him/her on the sled.
- Teacher have set up the cones and gives students directions
- Every student gets to be musher, so as they go around the cones, they also change positions. Teacher will specify where to change positions.
- When every body has been able to be a musher two times that group are the winners.

Physical Education By Mari Hoe-Raitto (Salsha)

Lesson #4: Overcoming Obstacles

Grade level: k-6

Objective: Obstacle course being part of a dog team/ or skijor

Equipment: Jump ropes, hula hoops, Sled dog mushing facts,
Other gym equipment to use as obstacles

- Teacher set up and obstacle course that a skijorer and a dog have to go through or a whole dog team and a musher.
- Use jump ropes if they are a whole team, and hula hoops if a skijorer.
- It can have several stations, like checkpoints for eating the right food (nutrition), making sure everybody is dressed right for the weather, etc.
- Each station has checkpoints with questions on the way that student have to try to answer before going on to the next.
- The obstacle course can be made up of anything you have in the gym or use the playground equipment as the obstacle course.

SLED DOG CAMP Cultural Week for Huslia's K - 6th Graders

April 8, 9, & 10, 2013: Monday, Tuesday, & Wednesday from 9:00am to 2:30pm

******Need JHS truck to bring classes to HENRY kennel on Monday & Tuesday morning. Walk to Attla kennel?******

MONDAY, April 8th: classes arrive at kennels with 2 teachers, a total of 8 high and middle school students (*up to 2 students will use film equipment*), and 1-2 adult volunteers

•9:30am= (7) K - 3rd graders (*those most comfortable with dogs*) head to ATTLA kennel

•9:30am= (8) 4th – 6th graders (*those most comfortable with dogs*) head to HENRY kennel

***Youth will stay at both kennels until 11:30ish: Classes will teach the below as time allows:**

- talk to youth about history of kennel and dogs in Huslia (inside cabin at Attla's) & safety in dog yard
- show youth a dog pot cooking or how it done
- instruct how to water dogs (Attla kennel will have 4 dippers & 4 buckets so youth can pair up)
- show how to pick up poop (Attla kennel has 2 shovels and 4 buckets so youth can pair up)
- show how to put straw in dog houses
- show how to harness dogs
- show how to clip and unclip dogs from chain by house
- show how to handle dog and clip on fence
- if time, show additional dog care like clip toe nails, put grease pads, and rub ligament on shoulders & back

•12:00pm= Kathy needs as many high and middle school students and volunteers at Attla kennel to be sure bush is blocking all trail side exits, to move 11 dogs to cable near racetrack starting line, and to move all sleds and gear so ready when youth to show up at racetrack. We will talk though plan for people positioned at starting line, out on trail, at finish line, and near dogs on cable.

•1:00pm= same (8) 4th - 6th graders head to racetrack ready to ride sled

•1:30pm= same (7) K - 3rd graders head to racetrack ready to ride sled (NOTE: they are at least half hour behind 4th - 6th graders showing up at racetrack)

At racetrack:

- There will be 3 LIGHT ADULT sleds for the (8) 4th - 6th graders to run 1-2 dog team on a short youth racetrack that goes behind Nathan's cabin. The start is to the left of normal racetrack start/finish line. The youth racetrack ends at the racetrack start/finish line. We get 2 teams ready at time so mushers leave soon after the other *****
- There will be 3 SMALLER sleds for the (7) K- 3rd graders to run 1 dog team on same short youth racetrack. We get 2 sleds s ready at time so mushers leave soon after the other.

******after running dogs, 4th - 6th graders can help K- 3rd graders and/or pet dogs on cable. I think we need a rule = THERE MUST BE AN ADULT WITH EACH CHILD PETTING OR HANDLING ANY DOG AT ANY TIME.**

NOTE: There will be 1 tan female dog tied to large silver post – her name is **CHILLI** and she looooooves to be pet. She is retired due to injury of both front ankles and is the gentlest dog in the yard. She also has the softest fur.

Also, I will have **DOG NAME** signs on short posts in snow behind each dog so that youth know their name:)!

TUESDAY, April 9th: classes arrive at kennels with 2 teachers, a total of 8 high and middle school students (up to 2 students will use film equipment), and 1-2 adult volunteers

•9:30am= new batch of (7) K - 3rd graders (next most comfortable with dogs) head to HENRY kennel

•9:30am= new batch of (8) 4th – 6th graders (next most comfortable with dogs) head to ATTILA kennel

***Youth will stay at both kennels until 11:30ish: Classes will teach the below as time allows:**

- talk to youth about history of kennel and dogs in Huslia (inside cabin at Attla's) & safety in dog yard
- show youth a dog pot cooking or how it done
- instruct how to water dogs (Attla kennel will have 4 dippers & 4 buckets so youth can pair up)
- show how to pick up poop (Attla kennel has 2 shovels and 4 buckets so youth can pair up)
- show how to put straw in dog houses
- show how to harness dogs
- show how to clip and unclip dogs from chain by house
- show how to handle dog and clip on fence
- if time, show additional dog care like clip toe nails, put grease pads, and rub ligament on shoulders & back

•12:00pm= Kathy needs as many high and middle school students and volunteers at Attla kennel to be sure bush is blocking all trail side exits, to move 11 dogs to cable near racetrack starting line, and to move all sleds and gear so ready when youth to show up at racetrack. We will talk though plan for people positioned at starting line, out on trail, at finish line, and near dogs on cable.

•1:00pm= same next new batch of (8) 4th - 6th graders head to racetrack ready to ride sled

•1:30pm= same next new batch of (7) K - 3rd graders head to racetrack ready to ride sled
(NOTE: they are at least half hour behind 4th - 6th graders showing up at racetrack)

At racetrack:

- There will be 3 LIGHT ADULT sleds for these (8) 4th - 6th graders to run 1-2 dog team on a short youth racetrack that goes behind Nathan's cabin. The start is to the left of normal racetrack start/finish line. The youth racetrack ends at the racetrack start/finish line. We get 2 teams ready at time so mushers leave soon after the other *****
- There will be 3-4 SMALLER sleds for these (7) K- 3rd graders to run 1-dog on same short youth racetrack. We get 2 sleds s ready at time so mushers leave soon after the other.

******after running dogs, 4th - 6th graders can help K- 3rd graders and/or pet dogs on cable. I think we need a rule = THERE MUST BE AN ADULT WITH EACH CHILD PETTING OR HANDLING ANY DOG AT ANY TIME.**

NOTE: There will be 1 tan female dog tied to large silver post – her name is **CHILLI** and she looooooves to be pet. She is retired due to injury of both front ankles and is the gentlest dog in the yard. She also has the softest fur.

Also, I will have **DOG NAME** signs on short posts in snow behind each dog so that youth know their name:)!

WEDNESDAY, April 10th: classes arrive at kennels with 2 teachers, a total of 8 high and middle school students (up to 2 students will use film equipment), and 1-2 adult volunteers

•9:30am= last batch of (8) K - 3rd graders (next most comfortable with dogs) head to ATTILA kennel

***Youth will stay at both kennels until 11:30ish: Classes will teach the below as time allows:**

- talk to youth about history of kennel and dogs in Huslia (inside cabin at Attla's) & safety in dog yard
- show youth a dog pot cooking or how it done
- instruct how to water dogs (Attla kennel will have 4 dippers & 4 buckets so youth can pair up)
- show how to pick up poop (Attla kennel has 2 shovels and 4 buckets so youth can pair up)
- show how to put straw in dog houses
- show how to harness dogs
- show how to clip and unclip dogs from chain by house
- show how to handle dog and clip on fence
- if time, show additional dog care like clip toe nails, put grease on paw pads, and rub ligament on shoulders & back

•12:00pm= Kathy needs as many high and middle school students and volunteers at Attla kennel to be sure bush is blocking all trail side exits, to move 7 dogs to cable near racetrack starting line, and to move all sleds and gear so ready when youth to show up at racetrack. We will talk though plan for people positioned at starting line, out on trail, at finish line, and near dogs on cable.

•1:00pm= last batch of (8) K - 3rd graders head to racetrack ready to ride sled

At racetrack:

- There will be 3-4 SMALLER sleds for these **(8) K- 3rd graders** to run 1-dog on same short youth racetrack. We will get 2 sleds ready at time so mushers leave soon after the other.

******after running dogs, K- 3rd graders can stick around and/or pet dogs on cable. Again, I think we need a rule = THERE MUST BE AN ADULT WITH EACH CHILD PETTING OR HANDLING ANY DOG AT ANY TIME.**

•2:00pm= HEADSTART youngsters with parents, teachers, high & middle school students, adult volunteers, and any youth be at racetrack ready to ride sled

At racetrack:

- There will be 3-4 SMALLER sleds for the **HEADSTART youngsters** to run 1-dog on last 100 feet of normal racetrack. There will people at both ends of a short run like we have done during village races!

NOTE: There will be 1 tan female dog tied to large silver post – her name is **CHILLI** and she looooooves to be pet. She is retired due to injury of both front ankles and is the gentlest dog in the yard. She also has the softest fur.

Also, I will have **DOG NAME** signs on short posts in snow behind each dog so that youth know their name:)!

****** For dogs on cable not being used for HEADSTART youngsters, Kathy needs people to bring them back to kennel. When event is over, she will also need help returning equipment as she does not have a working snow machine!**

References for ES and MS teachers

SPIRIT OF THE WIND (movie) curriculum

ALASKA SPORTS HALL OF FAME Healthy Heros Program Feature about George Attla

SPIRIT OF THE WIND: An instructional unit in Alaska State History

Written by Dr. Ronald Smith, University of Alaska-Fairbanks Professor of Zoology, Emeritus

Introduction:

SPIRIT OF THE WIND: An instructional unit in Alaska State History is a stand-alone unit incorporating elements and readings about George Attla, perhaps the most famous Alaska musher ever. Aspects of his and Athabascan life and culture are explored through viewing *Spirit of the Wind*, George's story up to 1979, plus related readings.

This instructional unit is not designed as a complete semester-long course in Alaska state history. Rather, it addresses selected aspects of the body of knowledge expected of students completing such a course. It can be used to augment an existing course or as an introduction to Alaska state history.

The elements of Alaska history recognized by the Alaska Board of Education as needed in such a course are listed below. This unit focuses, in part, on aspects of Alaska geography, Alaska's cultures, and modern Alaska.

High School Graduation Requirement:

After a statewide advocacy effort, led by the Alaska Humanities Forum, the State Board of Education amended 4AAC 06.075. This regulation now requires that as of January 1, 2009, the three units of social studies required for graduation must include one-half unit of credit in Alaska history or demonstration that the student meets the Alaska history performance standards. This does not apply to a student (1) who transfers into an Alaska public school after the student's second year of high school or (2) has already successfully completed a high school state history course from another state.

Some elements of Alaska state history:

- Geography: <http://www.akhistorycourse.org/articles/article.php?artID=313>
- Alaska's Cultures: <http://www.akhistorycourse.org/articles/article.php?artID=315>
- Russia's Colony: <http://www.akhistorycourse.org/articles/article.php?artID=316>
- America's Territory: <http://www.akhistorycourse.org/articles/article.php?artID=316>
- Governing Alaska- <http://www.akhistorycourse.org/articles/article.php?artID=318>
- Modern Alaska: <http://www.akhistorycourse.org/articles/article.php?artID=318>

Materials for the unit:

Spirit of the Wind: the life of George Attla and his sled dog racing

Study Guide with additional references to:

George Attla
tuberculosis
dog racing
trapping
subsistence fishing
boarding schools
the Molly Hootsch decision
the relocation of Alaska bush villages

Reading assignments and focus questions for the student to address

An "open book" written assessment

Alaska Native Heritage Center

ATHABASCANS

01-01-2000

Who We Are



The Athabascans traditionally lived in Interior Alaska, an expansive region that begins south of the Brooks Mountain Range and continues down to the Kenai Peninsula. There are eleven linguistic groups of Athabascans in Alaska. Athabaskan people have traditionally lived along five major river ways: the Yukon, the Tanana, the Susitna, the Kuskokwim, and the Copper river drainages. Athabascans were highly nomadic, traveling in small groups to fish, hunt and trap.

Today, Athabascans live throughout Alaska and the Lower 48, returning to their home territories to harvest traditional resources. The Athabaskan people call themselves 'Dena,' or 'the people.' In traditional and contemporary practices Athabascans are taught respect for all living things. The most important part of Athabaskan subsistence living is sharing. All hunters are part of a kin-based network in which they are expected to follow traditional customs for sharing in the community.

House Types and Settlements

The Athabascans traditionally lived in small groups of 20 to 40 people that moved systematically through the resource territories. Annual summer fish camps for the entire family and winter villages served as base camps. Depending on the season and regional resources, several traditional house types were used.

Tools and Technology

Traditional tools and technology reflect the resources of the regions. Traditional tools were made of stone, antlers, wood, and bone. Such tools were used to build houses, boats, snowshoes, clothing, and cooking utensils. Birch trees were used wherever they were found.

Social Organization

The Athabascans have matrilineal system in which children belong to the mother's clan, rather than to the father's clan, with the exception of the Holikachuk and the Deg Hit'an. Clan elders made decisions concerning marriage, leadership, and trading customs. Often the core of the traditional group was a woman and her brother, and their two families. In such a combination the brother and his sister's husband often became hunting partners for life. Sometimes these hunting partnerships started when a couple married.

Traditional Athabascan husbands were expected to live with the wife's family during the first year, when the new husband would work for the family and go hunting with his brothers-in-law. A central feature of traditional Athabascan life was (and still is for some) a system whereby the mother's brother takes social responsibility for training and socializing his sister's children so that the children grow up knowing their clan history and customs.

Clothing

Traditional clothing reflects the resources. For the most part, clothing was made of caribou and moose hide. Moose and caribou hide moccasins and boots were important parts of the wardrobe. Styles of moccasins vary depending on conditions. Both men and women are adept at sewing, although women traditionally did most of skin sewing.

Transportation

Canoes were made of birch bark, moose hide, and cottonwood. All Athabascans used sleds --with and without dogs to pull them – snowshoes and dogs as pack animals.

Trade

Trade was a principle activity of Athabascan men, who formed trading partnerships with men in other communities and cultures as part of an international system of diplomacy and exchange. Traditionally, partners from other tribes were also, at times, enemies, and travelling through enemy territory was dangerous.

Regalia

Traditional regalia varies from region to region. Regalia may include men's beaded jackets, dentalium shell necklaces (traditionally worn by chiefs), men and women's beaded tunics and women's beaded dancing boots.

Assignment 1: Watch the movie Spirit of the Wind. It portrays the life of George Attla up to the year 1979. Be prepared to answer the following questions about the movie and his life:

1. How did George Sr., George's father, run his trap line? That is, what was his means of transportation?
2. What was the source of heat for the family cabin?
3. How did the Attla family buy the goods they couldn't catch, grow, or make themselves?
4. How did the family reach summer fish camp?
5. At what age did George contract tuberculosis?
6. Where did he go for treatment and cure?
7. How long was he away from his home?
8. Where did he attend school while he was being treated for tuberculosis?
9. Where is the Fur Rendezvous World Championship race held?

Assignment 2: Go online and read this 2009 article on the making of the movie:

http://attlamakingofachampion.com/wp-content/uploads/2011/12/2009.10.00-First-Alaskans-Magazine_RJ.jpg

Assignment 3: Read the newspaper article about George's first Fur Rondy win:

http://attlamakingofachampion.com/wp-content/uploads/2011/12/1958.02.24-ADT-Attla-Dog-mushing-Champion-COMP_RJ.jpg

1. Write down the route he took to get from Huslia to the Fur Rondy race site.
2. How many methods of transportation did he use?
3. On a map of Alaska, figure out how many miles he traveled to get to the race.

Assignment 4: If you are interested in sled dogs, read the article on the origins of Alaskan sled dogs: http://www.sleddogcentral.com/features/little_wolf/alaskans.htm

Assignment 5: An important piece of Alaska history was made by both non-native and Alaska native mushers: the 1918 serum run from Nenana to Nome. Read the article about the serum run:

Assignment 6: Working with sled dogs may have unintended or unexpected benefits. Read the interview of George in Mushing Magazine in which he talks about how working with dogs influenced the way he raised his children: <http://attlamakingofachampion.com/wp-content/uploads/2011/12/2012.03-Mushing-Magazine-Part-II-Attla.pdf>

1. Summarize or describe how he saw the connection.
2. Might there be a similar benefit from raising and training hunting dogs? Pet dogs? Explain in a paragraph or two your reasoning.

Assignment 7: Late in life, George used his energies to establish a dog mushing program for middle and high school students in Huslia. This is, perhaps, another unexpected benefit

of working with sled dogs. Read his obituary:

<http://www.adn.com/print/article/20150215/famed-alaska-musher-george-attla-dead-81>

1. Write a paragraph, based on the obituary and perhaps the interview you read, about how the Frank Attla Youth and Sled Dog Care Mushing Program could benefit Alaskan youth. Use your imagination and your understanding about personal accomplishment as it relates to a person's self-image. Please discuss this assignment with your parents. They will have definite ideas to share with you.
2. Develop a short list of activities in which you are or could be involved that might build your confidence and sense of self-worth in a way similar to the mushing program just mentioned in the obituary.

Assignment 8: Recall in the movie that when George finally returned to his family and community he had been removed from his culture for almost ten years. He had a different set of experiences than his brother. He knew less about the fish wheel and its operation than his brother. In many respects, he was caught between two cultures due, in part, to his boarding school experience. Read the article on cultural assimilation of Native Americans as background for the next assignment:

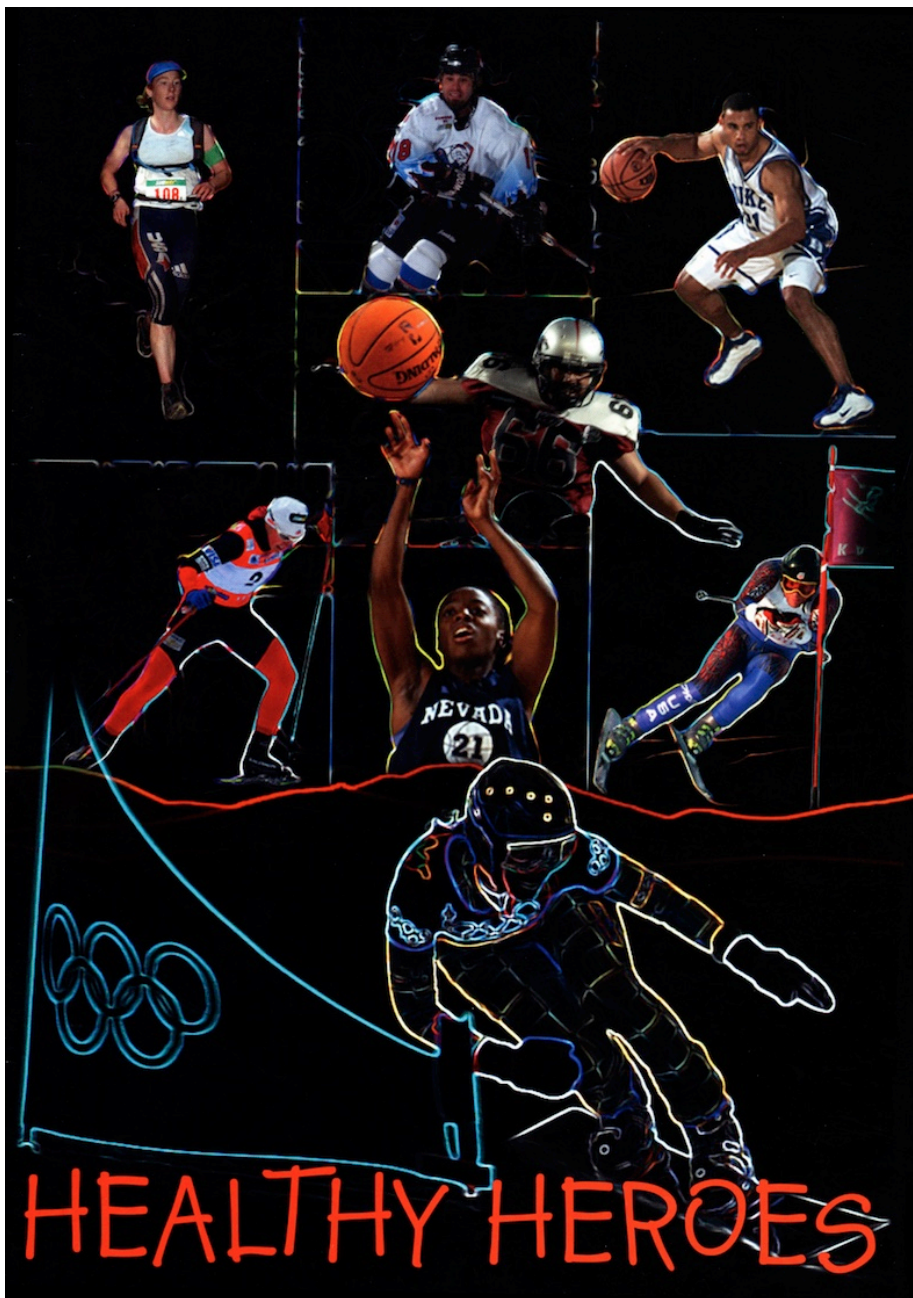
wikipedia.org/wiki/Cultural_assimilation_of_Native_Americans#Non-reservation_boarding_schools

Assignment 9: In the 1960s and, perhaps earlier, Alaska villagers, mostly native, began to push for local village high schools. They were seeking to preserve family and cultural unity. Read *Tobeluk v Lind*, the court case that led to a resolution of this issue:

wikipedia.org/wiki/Tobeluk_v_Lind

See also, the article on the Molly Hootch decision, the legal resolution of the law suit:
http://www.alaskool.org/native_ed/law/mhootch_erq.html

1. How many high school-age students does it take to require the state of Alaska to supply a village high school?
2. Who was Molly Hootch?
3. Make a list of five reasons why you might not like to be sent hundreds or thousands of miles away from home to a boarding school.
4. Suggest one potential advantage that might come to you at a boarding school. You might want to write paragraphs to answer these last two challenges.



ConocoPhillips Healthy Futures is a community initiative to provide Alaska's youth with greater access to positive role models in sports through the Healthy Heroes project. Founding partners in the project include the Municipality of Anchorage Parks & Recreation, the Anchorage School District, and the Alaska Association for Health, Physical Education, Recreation & Dance ConocoPhillips Healthy Futures initiative and the Alaska Sports Hall of Fame.

This project would not be possible without the efforts of the outstanding Alaskan athletes who contributed their inspiring messages.

The written submissions have been edited here for space considerations. Visit the Healthy Heroes home at www.alaskasportshall.org to read the Healthy Hero contributions in their entirety and find out about opportunities to chat online with your favorite Healthy Hero!

Photos courtesy of Sharbel Dussault, Bob Hill, Erik Hill, Devon Kershaw, Clark James Michler, Eric Teela, Anchorage Daily News, Dallas Morning News, Duke Athletic Department, and the Leadville Times



Anchorage School District
Educating All Students for Success in Life



ConocoPhillips
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An initiative of the Alaska Association for Health,
Physical Education, Recreation and Dance
www.healthyfuturesak.org

ANCHORAGE



PARKS & RECREATION

EXERCISE

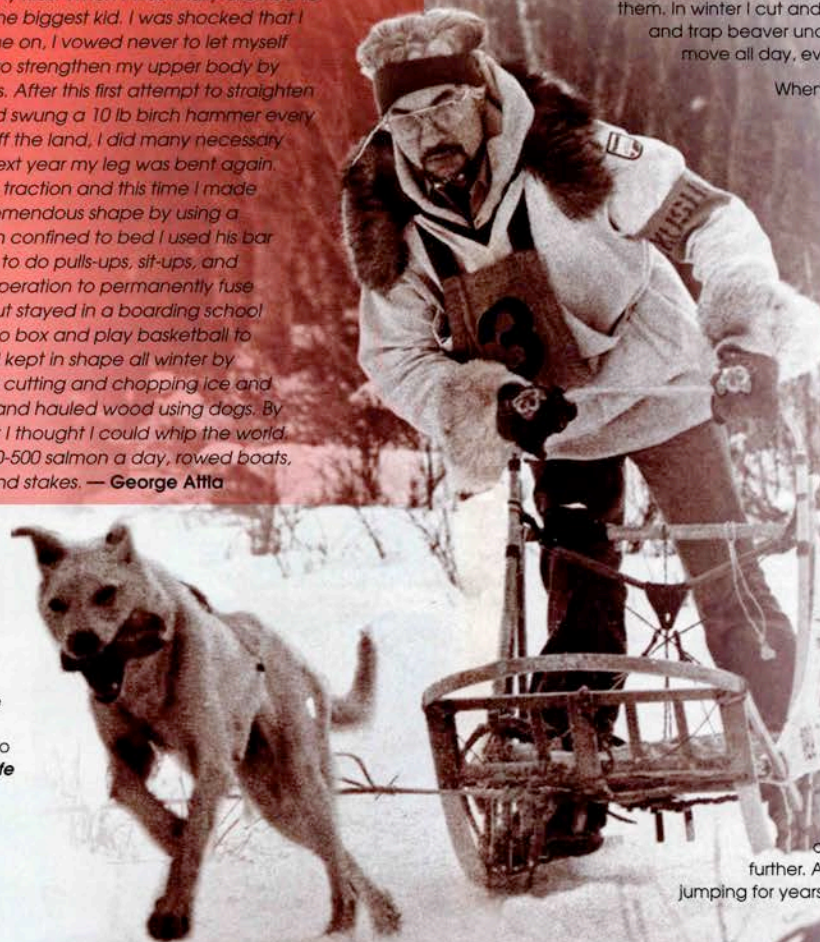
I lived in a remote part of Interior Alaska with my family until I was around eight years old when I contracted tuberculosis in my knee and was sent away to a hospital. At that time the only known way to keep use of my leg was to be put in traction, so I was forced to stay in bed and be totally constricted for over a month. My body became very weak from the inactivity. While stuck in a hospital bed, I was pestered by many kids. When I was finally allowed to get up, I was mad and went after the biggest kid. I was shocked that I was so easily beat up. From that time on, I vowed never to let myself get out of shape. I started working to strengthen my upper body by doing pull-ups, push-ups, and sit-ups. After this first attempt to straighten my leg, I went back to the bush and swung a 10 lb birch hammer every morning. In helping my family live off the land, I did many necessary chores like packing wood. By the next year my leg was bent again. I went back in the hospital for more traction and this time I made friends with a janitor, who kept in tremendous shape by using a spring bar and weights. Once again confined to bed I used his bar and weights daily, while continuing to do pulls-ups, sit-ups, and push-ups. At 15 years old after an operation to permanently fuse my knee, I got out of the hospital but stayed in a boarding school for two years where I learned how to box and play basketball to stay fit. I then went back home and kept in shape all winter by setting beaver traps which entailed cutting and chopping ice and snow shoeing, plus I ran a trap-line and hauled wood using dogs. By spring I felt in such good shape that I thought I could whip the world. In summer, I hauled fish nets, cut 400-500 salmon a day, rowed boats, and used a sledge hammer to pound stakes. — **George Attla**

What do you do on an average day to exercise?

It doesn't matter how long you exercise or what activity you choose for your exercise. It matters that you get out and do it every day! — **Aelin Peterson**

He ran everywhere. If you served under his command in the military, the only time that you were permitted to walk was if you were with a higher ranking officer who was walking. — **Col. Norman Vaughn's wife Carolyn on Norman**

Make sure the activities or sports you choose are fun and enjoyable. Make daily activity a part of your healthy lifestyle. — **Dick Mize**



EXERCISE

I try to go to the gym five days a week. I lift weights and either ride the bike or run for 40 minutes. — **Dean Larson**

I started forming good habits early on, so now it's no problem for me to work out three times a week from 5:30 to 7:00 a.m. — **Eric Heil**

I carry 20 gallons of water everyday to feed my dogs three times a day plus I pick up after them. In winter I cut and haul all my firewood, shovel snow, travel by snow machine and trap beaver under the ice. In summer I set nets to catch salmon. Basically I move all day, everyday. — **George Attla**

When you have a spare hour and can either choose to watch TV or get in a workout, make the decision that will benefit you the most. — **Karen Patten**

My average day of exercise usually includes two workouts. I start my first workout around 8:00 a.m. and train one to two hours. My second workout is at 4:00 p.m. and ranges from 30 min - 1 hr. — **Kikkan Randall**

You don't have to run marathons. Just walking – something almost all of us can do – is great exercise and a great way to start down the path of being active everyday. — **Kris Thorsness**

Alaskans have an advantage in that the wilderness is usually just out our back door, inviting us out. It is easy to stay healthy when hiking, fishing, berry picking and snow shoveling are part of everyday life. — **Libby Riddles**

I try to make up for my bad eating habits by being very active. Basketball is my favorite sport. I try to play basketball at least two to five times per week. — **Ma'o Tosi**

Everybody uses a car, but I used to run, ski, or bike seven miles to work. I wasn't the best dressed person in the office, but I kept a change of clothes I could get in and out of. — **Stan Justice**

For exercise I play basketball, lift weights and do some long distance jogging. — **Trajan Langdon**

I try to ski a lot and go for walks. Nordic skiing is also fun in the winter. — **Tommy Moe**

I stretch, stretch, stretch, strengthening my body to do anything I want it to, which is important for all of the different type of Alaska Native Games events. I build on my core stretches, adding weights to help gravity push me even further. After all of that work, my hope is that I will continue kicking and jumping for years to come. — **Phillip Blanchett**